

CS PROJECT II – PROPOSAL DEFENSE PRESENTATION GUIDELINES

Presentation Duration

- **Total Duration:** 20 minutes
- **Presentation:** 10–15 minutes
- **Question & Answer Session:** Approximately 5 minutes (or as directed by the examination panel).

Presentation Slides

- Prepare 10–12 slides that clearly and concisely cover all the required sections of your proposal.

Audience

- Proposal defense sessions are **open to members of the Strathmore University community** with access to the meeting link.
- Present your work professionally, remain composed, and focus on demonstrating your understanding of the proposed project.

General Examination Requirements

1. Cameras

Your camera **must remain switched on throughout the entire proposal defence**. Ensure your face is clearly visible at all times unless otherwise instructed by the examination panel.

2. Dress Code

Students are expected to adhere to **Strathmore University's dress code**. Attire should be **formal, neat, and appropriate for an academic examination**.

3. Examination Environment

Present from a **quiet, well-lit, and distraction-free environment**. Ensure that your background is clean and professional, and that interruptions are kept to a minimum throughout the examination.

4. Audio & Internet Connection

Use a reliable internet connection and test your microphone, camera, and presentation equipment before your scheduled session. Where possible, use headphones to improve audio quality and minimize background noise.

5. Professional Conduct

Maintain professionalism throughout the defence. Be punctual, respectful, attentive, and courteous to the examination panel. Listen carefully to questions, respond honestly and confidently, and follow all instructions provided by the examiners.

6. Academic Integrity

The proposal defence is an individual academic assessment. Students are expected to present and defend **their own work**. Any form of academic dishonesty, unauthorized assistance, plagiarism, impersonation, or other examination misconduct will be handled in accordance with the University's academic integrity policies.

7. Presentation Readiness

Join the meeting **at least 10 minutes before your scheduled presentation time** with your presentation slides ready to share. Ensure your device is fully

charged (or connected to power) and close any unnecessary applications that may interrupt the presentation.

8. Device and Participation

Each student **must join the defence using their own device unless prior approval has been granted by the examination panel**. Students should not present from shared devices or locations that may compromise examination integrity or create distractions.

9. Session Recording:

Proposal defence sessions **will not be recorded due to storage limitations**. Students are encouraged to **take notes** or **record their own presentation** for future reference and to capture the panel's feedback. You may use **third party applications** to do this.

Recommended Presentation Structure

Slide 1 – Cover Slide

Include:

- Project Title
- Student Name
- Admission Number
- Class (e.g., ICS4A)
- Supervisor Name
- Department
- Date (optional)

What the panel is looking for

- A concise, professional, and descriptive project title.

- A title that clearly reflects the project's purpose.
 - Professional presentation and formatting.
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Slide 2 – Background

Include

- Brief context of the problem domain.
- Current situation.
- Existing challenges.
- Why does the problem matter?
- Statistics or evidence where applicable.

What the panel is looking for

- Demonstrates understanding of the application domain.
 - Explains why the problem exists.
 - Uses evidence rather than assumptions.
 - Leads naturally into the problem statement.
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Slide 3 – Problem Statement

Include

- Clearly state the problem.
- Who is affected?
- Why is the current solution inadequate?
- Consequences if the problem remains unsolved.

What the panel is looking for

- A specific and researchable problem.
 - A real need—not simply “I want to build an app.”
 - Clear motivation for the project.
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Slide 4 – Objectives & Justification

Include

- General Objective
- One clear statement.
- Specific Objectives
- 3–5 SMART objectives.
- Justification
- Why is this project important?
- Who benefits?
- Expected impact.

What the panel is looking for

- Objectives align with the problem.
 - Objectives are measurable.
 - Strong practical or research justification.
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Slide 5 – Literature Review

Include

- Existing systems or research.
- Key theories or technologies.
- Comparison of related work.
- Avoid listing papers one after another.
- Instead compare them.

What the panel is looking for

- Understanding of existing solutions.
 - Ability to compare approaches.
 - Knowledge of current technologies.
 - Recent and credible references.
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Slide 6 – Research Gap

Include

- Clearly explain
- What current solutions fail to do.
- Limitations in previous work.
- How your project addresses those limitations.

What the panel is looking for

- A genuine research or technical gap.
 - Clear novelty.
 - Evidence that the project contributes something new or improved.
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Slide 7 – Technical Design / Architecture / Conceptual Framework

(Use whichever best suits your project.)

Examples

- System Architecture
- Conceptual Framework
- Workflow Diagram
- AI Pipeline
- Model Architecture
- Blockchain Architecture
- Network Architecture
- Database Design
- System Flow

Explain every major component.

What the panel is looking for

- Logical flow.

- Well-connected components.
 - Technical understanding.
 - Feasible design.
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Slide 8 – Technical Implementation Strategy

This is one of the most important slides.

Include: Depending on your project:

AI / ML / NLP / CV

- Dataset(s)
- Data source
- Data collection
- Data preprocessing
- Feature engineering
- Model training
- Model evaluation

Information Systems

- Users
- Database
- APIs
- Business workflow
- Backend
- Frontend

Blockchain

- Network
- Smart contracts
- Wallet
- Consensus
- Transactions

Cybersecurity

- Threat model
- Detection approach
- Security controls
- Testing strategy

IoT

- Sensors
- Hardware
- Communication
- Cloud
- Dashboard

Explain the complete workflow from input to output.

What the panel is looking for

- Feasible implementation.
 - Appropriate technologies.
 - Clear understanding of how the system will work.
 - Availability of required resources.
 - Practical implementation plan.
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Slide 9 – Methodology

Include

- Research or development methodology.

Examples

Agile - this is a group of iterative methodologies, specify which one used.

- SCRUM
- CRISP-DM
- Design Science Research
- Experimental Design

- Prototyping
- Modified Waterfall

Explain why it was selected.

What the panel is looking for

- Appropriate methodology.
 - Clear implementation process.
 - Alignment with project goals.
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Slide 10 – Evaluation Strategy

Include

- How will success be measured?

Examples

- **AI / ML**
 - Accuracy
 - Precision
 - Recall
 - F1 Score

Information Systems

- Usability Testing
- User Acceptance Testing
- Performance

Security

- Detection Rate
- False Positive Rate

Blockchain

- Throughput
- Latency
- Gas Cost

General Software

- Functional Testing
- Performance Testing
- User Satisfaction

What the panel is looking for

- Measurable evaluation.
 - Realistic validation plan.
 - Appropriate metrics.
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Slide 11 – Expected Outcomes

Include

- Expected system.
- Expected contribution.
- Expected users.
- Anticipated impact.

What the panel is looking for

- Clear deliverables.
 - Alignment with objectives.
 - Realistic expectations.
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Slide 12 – Questions

Simply

- Thank You
 - Questions?
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During the Q&A

The panel is assessing your understanding, not your ability to memorize slides.

Be prepared to explain:

- Why you chose this topic.
 - Why this problem matters.
 - Why you selected your methodology.
 - Why you selected particular technologies.
 - Why your proposed solution is feasible.
 - How your solution differs from existing work.
 - What datasets, APIs, users, or other resources you will use.
 - Potential limitations and risks.
 - How you intend to evaluate success.
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General Presentation Tips

- Keep the presentation to the allocated time.
 - Avoid reading directly from the slides.
 - Use diagrams instead of large blocks of text.
 - Ensure all figures are readable.
 - Use recent and credible references.
 - Be consistent with fonts, colors, and formatting.
 - Every slide should support your narrative—not overwhelm it.
 - Know your proposal thoroughly; the panel will often probe beyond what is shown on the slides.
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